

# Geo holdout test: brand search and retargeting (Feb - Apr 2025)

Why: both channels report a lot of conversions but we suspected many of those people would have contacted us anyway. We paused each one in a set of service-area clusters and left everything else running.

## ***Design***

Test window: 3 Feb 2025 to 27 Apr 2025 (12 weeks). Reference period before the test: 11 Nov 2024 to 2 Feb 2025 (12 weeks).

Brand search ads were switched off in clusters: G01, G02, G06, G10, G15, G17, G24.

Retargeting was switched off in clusters: G07, G08, G11, G14, G16, G19, G22.

Control: all other clusters, where both channels kept running as normal: G03, G04, G05, G09, G12, G13, G18, G20, G21, G23. Every other channel kept running in every cluster.

The pause clusters were picked by the regional manager from the busier markets so the effect would be easy to see. Cluster membership by zip code is in geo\_map.csv.

Spend for the two channels fell during the test because the paused clusters were not being served.

*Synthetic exercise document.*